



Gaming monitors

These are the most apparent gateways to your digital world. Regardless of that mini-supercomputer humming away at your feet, nothing would be possible in the digital world without a good display to complement the computing power at your disposal. A monitor is something you should never scrimp on, a good monitor will last longer than your PC and there's no point in having a 780Ti when you can't even properly see the pixels that it's pushing to your screen.

We haven't been seeing too much innovation in this segment, though the bump to 4k is one we are curious about. Sadly, we're yet to see even 1440p being adopted as a resolution of choice amongst gamers, though we will admit, price is quite a barrier. That said, if you're ready to spend 40k on a "gaming" monitor, spending that money on a higher resolution display might be more suitable.

Some interesting monitors we've seen have included NVIDIA's 3D Vision and webcams, but we truly feel that nothing beats a well-calibrated display running at 120Hz – everything else is either just a bonus or fluff. What we're looking for in our tests are monitors with an excellent response time, minimal ghosting and a great contrast ratio.

Zero1 winner BenQ GW2760HS

With a true 8-bit VA panel, this monitor is easily among the best monitors we've tested, in terms of image quality. The contrast ratio was a stellar 1200:1 based on our tests and this is more than we've ever seen before, including on the professional-grade monitors that pass through our test labs from time to time. This extreme contrast ratio is more a result of the inky blacks than blinding brightness and that's a very good thing as far as eye-strain goes. This monitor also fared fairly well in our tests for flicker and response time, easily out-classing many of the similarly priced moni-



▲ BenQ GW2760HS
Price: ₹21,000



ASUS VK278
Price: ₹24,000



BenQ XL2720T
Price: ₹35,000

tors. Professional monitors aside, this is the best 27-inch panel that you can buy today. We only wish the resolution was a bit higher.

Worthy mentions ASUS VK278

This monitor's a great all-rounder, a monitor with a nice balance of features and performance. The contrast ratio of 900:1 was second only to the GW2760HS mentioned earlier, with deep blacks that fall just short of the latter. Those blacks are coupled with a powerful backlight that helps boost the contrast ratio to the levels we measured. The monitor fared very well in our black level test and almost all the desired boxes were visible. We did notice an issue with flickering in our flicker tests, but we doubt anyone will actually notice as our tests are very harsh on the monitors. This monitor also packs in a webcam (and in effect, a mic) and a "dynamic" backlight system to help boost contrast in demanding situations. All these factors come together to create a monitor that is definitely worthy of mention in this category.

BenQ XL2720T

This monitor was a surprise winner for us. Right out of the box the colours were washed out and the backlight a bit too bright. The display seemed harsh and we didn't feel comfortable using the monitor. After half an hour spent calibrating the monitor however, there was a significant improvement. An improvement so marked that it might have been an entirely new monitor (a better one) that we were testing. Our Spyder 3 estimated the monitor's contrast ratio at 800:1, again a very high figure, but then again, you weren't expecting any less in this category were you?

To be very frank, the other monitors mentioned here were better in terms of image quality, but this one sneaks in an excellent refresh rate and a flicker-free display that smokes the competition. The XL2720T aced all of our flicker tests and while it didn't perform spectacularly well in our black and white saturation tests, the results weren't too bad either. What sets this monitor apart from the rest is the Nvidia 3D Vision integration. The device natively supports 3D Vision and the boosted brightness and skewed contrast that we initially noticed was because the monitor was actually trying to compensate for the slight dip in brightness and contrast that we would see while using the 3D glasses. This is definitely a must-buy if you have a 3D Vision kit lying around.